YOUR PARENTING PROFILE



The Molten Lava Cake

F C T E

Spontaneous outside, molten feelings at the center.

Your four letters

Your code is built from four research-backed parenting dimensions. Neither pole of any dimension is the better one.



F
HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY
Flow

C
WHO SETS THE DIRECTION
Captain

T
WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG
Talker

E
COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE
Explorer

For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.

AN EVERYDAY STORY

After the Brightest Part of the Day

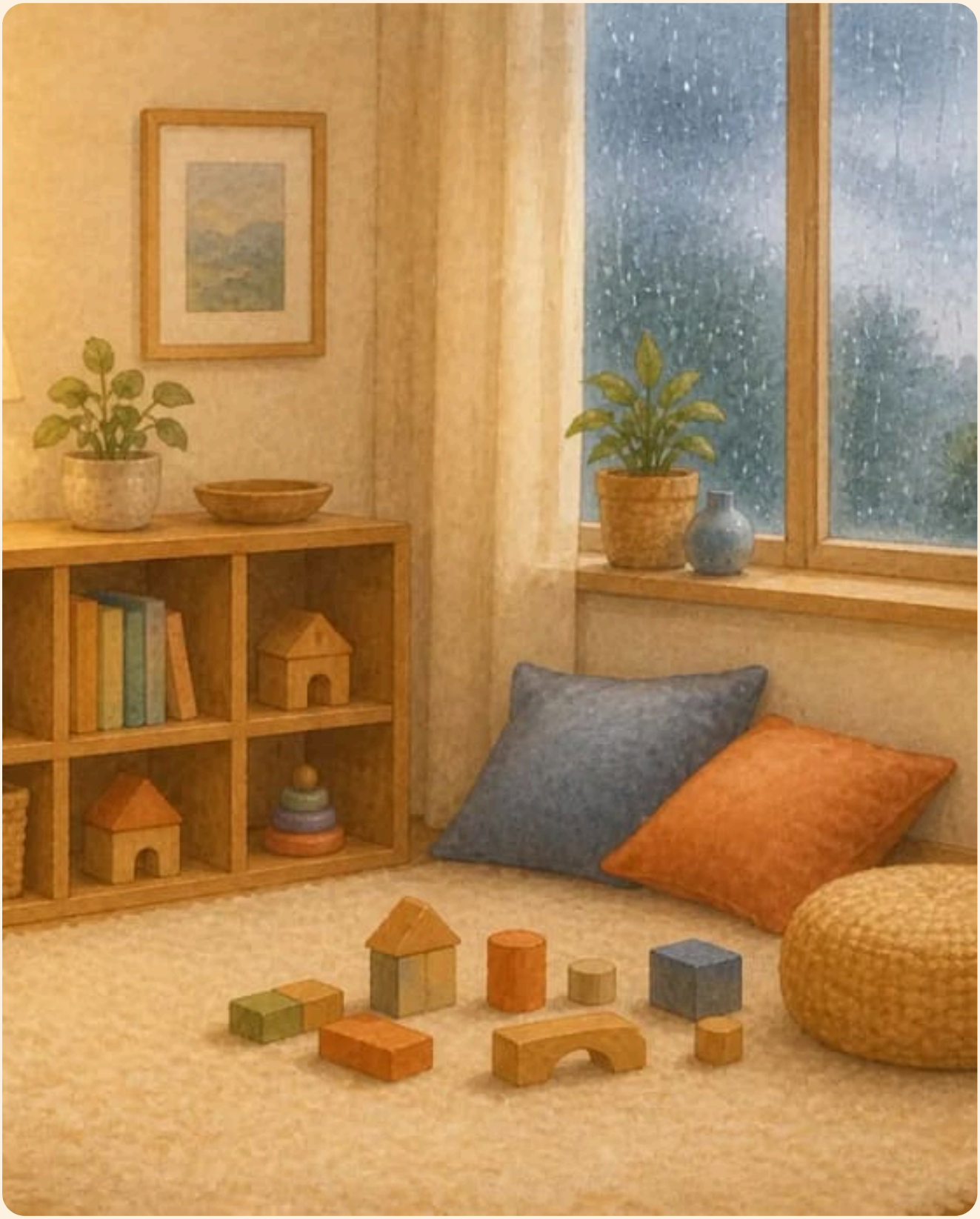
The afternoon begins with an unplanned dance in the rain. You and your child jump through puddles, laughing too loudly, and for an hour you are the most alive person in the world. By bedtime, the wet clothes, noise, and three unfinished tasks have emptied you. When your child asks for one more game, your voice erupts: “Enough!”

The silence afterward feels worse than the shouting. As a Molten Lava Cake parent, you know both temperatures, spontaneous joy on the outside, intense feeling at the center. Guilt tells you that changing energy makes you unsafe. But steadiness does not mean having one mood forever.



You take a shower, drink water, and message someone who can hold the adult part of the story. Then you return.

“My voice was too loud. That was my responsibility, not yours.” Your child leans against you. The day does not end at the rupture; it ends at the return. Tomorrow's anchor will be simple: one glass of water before bedtime begins. Not a perfect routine, just somewhere for both of you to land.



WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS

You bring energy, spontaneity, and big feelings. When your energy drops or an emotion spills over, the contrast can trigger guilt: “Why can't I be consistent?”

RELEASE THE GUILT

Stability does not mean staying in the same mood. Your child can live with changing energy; what matters is that they are not made responsible for your emotions and that you return after a hard moment.



YOUR SUPERPOWERS

1. Best no-plan adventure maker in the game
2. Big emotional honesty, your kid feels truly seen
3. You bring the spark to ordinary days

WATCH-OUT, WITH LOVE

Intensity spikes happen. One tiny anchor routine helps on the soft days. 🍫

YOUR POP-CULTURE COUSIN

Big-hearted fun parent



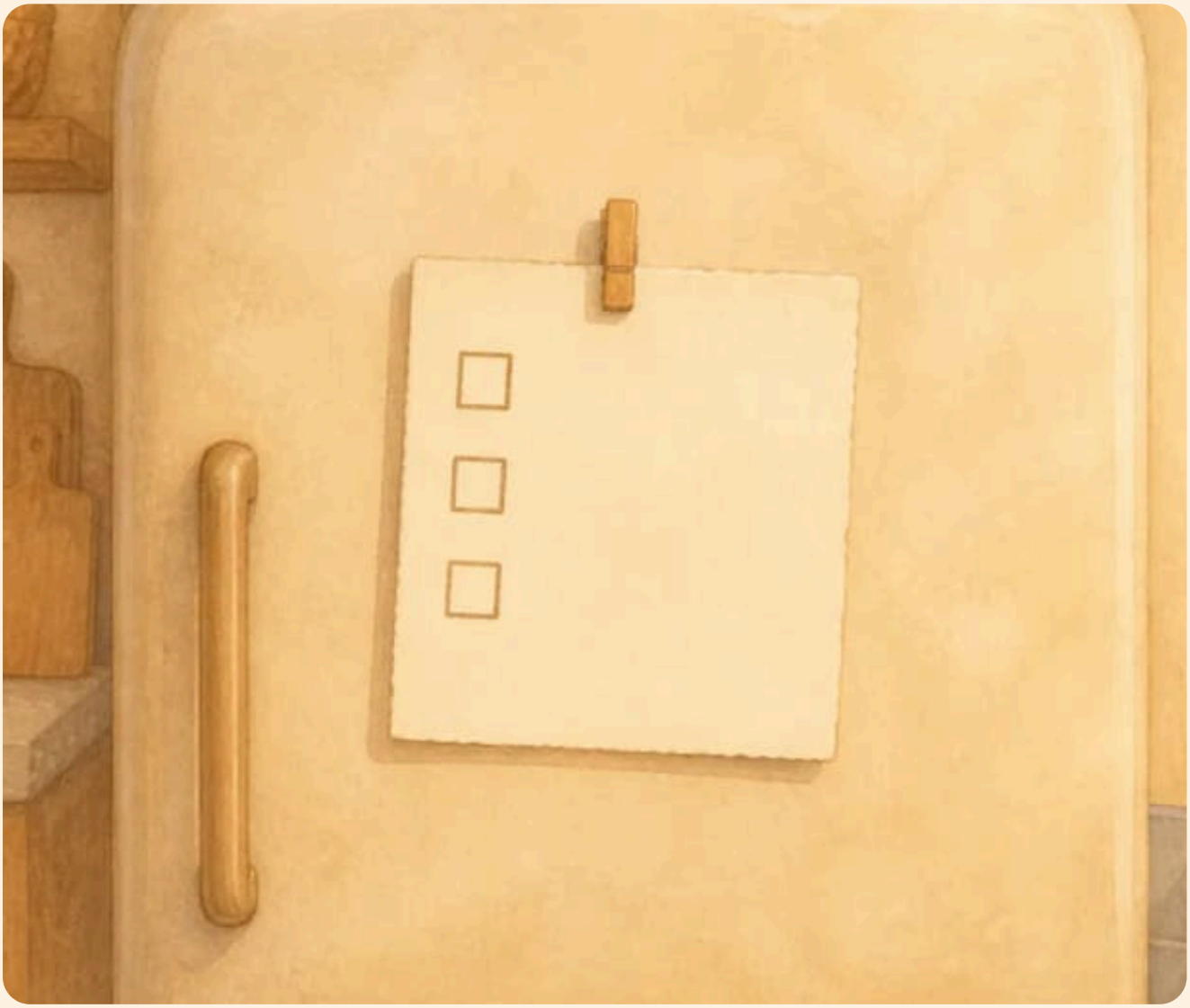
WHAT TO REMEMBER

Try this week

- [ ] Choose one daily anchor ritual
- [ ] Find one safe place for your adult feelings
- [ ] After an outburst, say: “My voice was too loud. That is my responsibility, not your fault.”

EXTRAS FOR YOUR STYLE

- [ ] Pick one routine and keep it all the way to the weekend.
- [ ] Give your child one genuine choice today — one where you'd accept either answer.
- [ ] After you name the feeling, stay quiet for ten seconds before anything else.
- [ ] Stop at the first try if they say that's enough.



FOR YOU FIRST

5 ways to come back to yourself

Chosen from your style: what you spend yourself on is what needs releasing. Not one of these is for your child.

There's an order most of us have backwards: everyone else gets looked after first, and you get whatever is left. But what's left at nine at night isn't you — it's the part of you that never got to rest.

The next five pages don't ask you to be a better parent. Nothing here is counted, nothing is reported, and not one of them is for your child. They're all for you, and they aren't a reward you have to earn first.

What's on them isn't random either. Every parenting style spends itself differently: some parents run out from anticipating, some from deciding, some from holding everybody's feelings. So whatever drains you most is also what most needs releasing.



WHAT DRAINS YOU MOST

F — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Deciding without a rail. Every hour asks for a fresh decision.

C — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Steering. You're the one who always has to know the next move.

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Absorbing feelings. Your ears have been on shift since morning.

E — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Being the energy. Every bit of the fun sets off from you first.

FOR YOU FIRST

Build one tiny anchor that survives a chaotic day, a drink, a shower, a song, or a message to someone safe.

HOW TO USE THESE

Take just one. If only one of these gets used this week, that worked. The rest stay here; they aren't going anywhere.

No time this week? You are still enough.



TIME 5 MIN

One drink while it's still hot

Almost every parent drinks their coffee cold. Not from lack of time, but because there is always one more thing that comes first.

Sit down. Finish the whole thing at its actual temperature, doing nothing else at the same time.



TIME 15 MIN

The basket that finds itself

Your rest often gets spent hunting for the things that make it rest. Recovery shouldn't need a search party.

One basket, one fixed place: your book, your charger, your hand cream, a snack that is actually yours.



TIME 5 MIN

The not-mine list

Some of what you're carrying genuinely isn't yours. Writing it down is more honest than promising to stop thinking about it.

Write three things that are not yours to fix today. Read them once, then leave the paper somewhere you'll see it.



TIME 2 MIN

Six long exhales

Two minutes, no equipment, can be done standing in the kitchen. For a parent who absorbs feelings all day, this is the cheapest reset there is.

Six breaths where the out-breath is longer than the in-breath. Slower than feels natural.



TIME 2 MIN

Twenty minutes earlier

The next adventure is better funded by sleep than by will. This is two minutes of setting, not twenty of losing.

Set one alarm tonight — not to wake up, to stop.

5 activities with your child (0–5)

One for each age range, so you can take the one that fits your child right now. Everything is already in your house.



THEN, FOR YOUR CHILD

Your child needs clear language that your outburst or exhaustion was not their fault, followed by the real experience that a relationship can be repaired.



0–12 MONTHS · 10 MIN

Just out of reach

Babies learn movement from effort, not from being handed things. That small gap is where the trying happens.

1. Lay your baby on a firm, flat surface.
2. Put one interesting object a hand's width past their fingers.
3. Say nothing and wait, even when it takes a while. Don't slide it closer.

You'll need: One object with texture or a soft sound.

Safety first: Firm surface, never a bed or a sofa edge. The object must be too big to pass through a toilet-paper tube.

Grounded in: Montessori — freedom of movement



1–2 YEARS · 10 MIN

Walk the tape line

One line becomes a balance beam, a road, or nothing at all. Whatever they turn it into is the activity.

1. Run a straight or curved line of tape along the floor.
2. Walk it once yourself, then stop directing.
3. Follow whatever rules they invent, even if they change every minute.

You'll need: Masking or washi tape.

Safety first: Clear the run of hard furniture corners. Bare feet or grippy socks.

Grounded in: Montessori — freedom of movement



2–3 YEARS · 10 MIN

Pour from a small jug

The classic Montessori presentation: show once, then hand over control completely.

1. Half-fill a small jug and set two cups on a tray.
2. Pour once, slowly, without narrating.
3. Put the cloth where they can reach it and say nothing about spills.

You'll need: A small unbreakable jug and two unbreakable cups, a tray, a cloth.

Safety first: Room-temperature water only. Use light, unbreakable vessels and keep an adult within arm's reach.

Grounded in: Montessori — practical life



3–4 YEARS · 20 MIN

Special play time

This is the weekly session used in filial therapy, run by the parent at home. If you try only one activity in this booklet, make it this one.

1. 20 minutes, one child, a consistent time and place, phone in another room.
2. They choose everything. You follow, and join in only when invited — no teaching, no questions, no suggestions.
3. Describe what you see ("You're giving the baby a bottle"), reflect what they feel ("That surprised you"), and praise the effort, never the result ("You kept trying until you got it").
4. Give a five-minute and a one-minute warning before you stop.

You'll need: Simple non-mechanical things: paper and crayons, a doll, animals, blocks, cars.

Safety first: Use intact, age-appropriate toys with no loose batteries or small parts. An adult stays in the room.

Grounded in: Filial therapy — special play time



4–5 YEARS · 15 MIN

A treasure map of our house

Drawing a map and then following it is symbolic thinking with legs.

1. They draw a map of a room, however inaccurate.
2. Hide a small soft toy or block together and mark it.
3. Follow their map, not your knowledge of the house.

You'll need: Paper, crayons, one small soft toy or block to hide.

Safety first: Agree which rooms are in play. If a child under three lives in the home, choose an object too large for a toilet-paper tube.

Grounded in: Montessori — order



No play today? You are still enough.

Keep it, print it, or forget it

This booklet has no targets and counts nothing. Take the one thing that helps and leave the rest.



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